Problem-Solution fit canvas 2.0

Project: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer | **Team ID:** SWTID-2026-7788
Purpose / Vision: Cut laptop procurement time, errors and manual effort by automating standard laptop orders end-to-end with ServiceNow Flow Designer.

Define CS, fit into CC

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) — CS

Who is your customer?
i.e. working parents of 0-5 y.o. kids

- **IT service desk agents** and **procurement officers** who process laptop requests
- **Employees and new joiners** who need a standard laptop for work
- **Line managers / approvers** who sign off on hardware requests
- **IT asset managers** in mid-to-large organisations already using ServiceNow

6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS — CC

What constraints prevent your customers from taking action or limit their choices of solutions? i.e. spending power, budget, no cash, network connection, available devices.

- Multi-level manual approvals across IT, finance and managers
- Fixed budget and a limited catalogue of approved standard models
- Small IT team; workload spikes during hiring and refresh cycles
- Dependence on vendor stock and delivery lead times
- Must follow procurement policy and stay audit-ready
- Limited low-code skills and existing ServiceNow licence scope

5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS — AS

Which solutions are available to the customers when they face the problem or need to get the job done? What have they tried in the past? What pros & cons do these solutions have? i.e. pen and paper is an alternative to digital notetaking

- **Email / phone / spreadsheets:** familiar and easy, but slow, error-prone, no tracking
- **Manual catalogue request + manual fulfilment:** some tracking, but POs and approvals still done by hand
- **Separate procurement suites (e.g. SAP Ariba):** powerful, but costly, complex and hard to integrate
- **Ours:** automated, policy-driven flow inside the existing ServiceNow platform

Explore AS, differentiate

Focus on J&P, tap into BE, understand RC

2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS — J&P

Which jobs-to-be-done (or problems) do you address for your customers? There could be more than one; explore different sides.

- **Jobs:** request a standard laptop, get it approved, raise the purchase order, track delivery, assign the asset to the user
- **Problems:** repetitive manual work for IT staff
- Long turnaround because of approval delays and follow-ups
- Incomplete or wrong request details causing rework and duplicate orders
- No real-time visibility of request status for users and managers

9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE — RC

What is the real reason that this problem exists?
What is the back story behind the need to do this job?
i.e. customers have to do it because of the change in regulations.

- Laptop ordering runs through disconnected steps (email, forms, spreadsheets)
- Approvals, PO creation and notifications are not automated
- Standard, predictable requests are handled like custom ones
- Growing headcount increases request volume, but the process was never standardised or integrated
- Pressure to cut cost and meet compliance and audit needs

7. BEHAVIOUR — BE

What does your customer do to address the problem and get the job done? i.e. directly related: find the right solar panel installer, calculate usage and benefits; indirectly associated: customers spend free time on volunteering work (i.e. Greenpeace)

- **Direct:** submit request by email or portal, chase approvers, verify configuration, create PO, update asset records by hand
- **Indirect:** keep personal spreadsheets, ask peers or the IT desk for status, escalate to managers
- Some employees buy outside the procurement process to save time
- IT staff batch requests to reduce repeated effort

Focus on J&P, tap into BE, understand RC

Identify strong TR & EM

3. TRIGGERS — TR

What triggers customers to act? i.e. seeing their neighbour installing solar panels, reading about a more efficient solution in the news.

- New-hire onboarding or hardware refresh cycle
- Faulty / end-of-life laptop; complaints about slow delivery
- Management push for automation, cost saving or audit findings

4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER — EM

How do customers feel when they face a problem or a job and afterwards? i.e. lost, insecure > confident, in control - use it in your communication strategy & design.

- **Before:** frustrated, uncertain, overloaded, waiting in the dark
- **After:** confident, in control, satisfied, time saved

10. YOUR SOLUTION — SL

If you are working on an existing business, write down your current solution first, fill in the canvas, and check how much it fits reality. If you are working on a new business proposition, then keep it blank until you fill in the canvas and come up with a solution that fits within customer limitations, solves a problem and matches customer behaviour.

- **ServiceNow Flow Designer** workflow that automates standard laptop orders end-to-end
- Catalogue item 'Standard Laptop' triggers the flow when a request is submitted
- Auto-approval rules by role and cost limit; only exceptions go to a manual approver
- Auto-creates the purchase order / vendor task and sends email notifications at every stage
- Auto-updates asset records and closes the request on delivery
- Status dashboard for users, managers and IT, so problems are seen early

8. CHANNELS of BEHAVIOUR — CH

8.1 ONLINE What kind of actions do customers take online? Extract online channels from #7

- ServiceNow portal / catalogue for requests and status tracking
- Email and Teams / Slack notifications; approvals by link

8.2 OFFLINE What kind of actions do customers take offline? Extract offline channels from #7 and use them for customer development.

- Talking to the IT desk or manager; onboarding / HR meetings
- Physical laptop handover with asset tag; calls to vendor

Extract online & offline CH of BE

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